RUNBOOK

Claude just got access to financial accounts

Not a feature story. A permissions story.

- Anthropic extended Claude into financial data access
- Reported within the last couple hours
- Comes while the market debates what Claude is actually worth

WHY IT'S BLOWING UP

Agents are moving into systems that matter

This is a different category than chat or summaries

- Reading bank data means touching real money and real risk
- Different from drafting emails or pulling web results
- First real test of agents inside sensitive systems

THE SHIFT

From reading to operating

There's a line between the two, and it matters

- Summarizing data: low risk, easy to reverse
- Acting on data: high risk, hard to reverse
- Financial access sits right on that line

THE REAL QUESTION

It's not what Claude can see

It's what Claude can do once it sees it

- Read access and act access are not the same thing
- Viewing a balance is not the same as moving money
- The permission model decides which one you're building

WHAT TO CHECK

Three questions before trusting any agent here

Ask these before you plug an agent into anything financial

- What data can it see, and nothing more?
- What actions can it take without a human?
- Where does a person have to approve the step?

WHERE HUMANS STILL BELONG

Approval steps aren't a limitation

They're the reason you can trust the system at all

- Full autonomy sounds good until something breaks
- A review step costs seconds, a bad transaction costs more
- Good agent design builds the checkpoint in from day one

HOW THIS PLAYS OUT ELSEWHERE

Same logic applies outside finance

CRM, inboxes, contracts, anything with consequences

- Any agent touching sensitive data needs the same split
- Read vs act, logged vs silent, reviewed vs automatic
- The tool changes, the permission model doesn't

TAKEAWAY

Judge agent news by the guardrails, not the headline

The feature is easy. The access control is the work

- Ask what the agent can see before asking what it can do
- Ask where a human still signs off
- That answer tells you if it's ready for real use

CTA

Building something that touches sensitive data?

Happy to compare notes on how you're structuring access and approval.

- What's the one system you'd never let an agent touch unsupervised?

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